

edit (Figure 2). For Scilab, a complete file is written by Samuel Gougeon and is available from <https://fileexchange.scilab.org/toolboxes/14000>.

Firefox and Thunderbird

The user and not the software must determine whether or not to install updates. The use of internal options of each program may not work, so an alternative way is presented here. To disable the installation of add-ons, it is necessary to put two files in four directories, according to the following schema:

```
C:\Program Files\Mozilla Firefox\defaults\pref\local-
settings.js
C:\Program Files\Mozilla Firefox\mozilla.cfg
C:\Program Files\Mozilla Thunderbird\defaults\pref\local-
settings.js
C:\Program Files\Mozilla Thunderbird\mozilla.cfg
```

To turn off the updates of each application, one file must be added to your profile:

```
C:\Users\[your-username]\AppData\Roaming\Mozilla\Firefox\
Profiles\[your-profile].default\user.js
C:\Users\[your-username]\AppData\Roaming\Thunderbird\Profiles\
[your-profile].default\user.js
```

The contents of these three files are as follows:

```
// local-settings.js
pref("general.config.obscure_value",0);
pref("general.config.filename","mozilla.cfg");
// mozilla.cfg
lockPref("xpinstall.enabled",false);
// user.js
user_pref("app.update.enabled",false);
```

One of the easiest things about Firefox and Thunderbird is how to do a backup. I'm comfortable using the following batch script. A copy of each directory with the current date is created on the desktop.

```
@rem Backup for Firefox and Thunderbird
@rem Copy from source to destination including subdirs and
hidden
@echo off
@for /F "tokens=1,2,3 delims=/ " %A in ('date /t') do @
set Day=%A
set Month=%B
set Year=%C
set All=%C-%B-%A
)
mkdir C:\Users\[your-username]\Desktop\Mozilla_%All%
C:\Windows\System32\xcopy.exe C:\Users\[your-username]\
AppData\Roaming\Mozilla C:\Users\[your-username]\Desktop\
```

```
Mozilla_%All% /S /E /H
mkdir C:\Users\[your-username]\Desktop\Thunderbird_%All%
C:\Windows\System32\xcopy.exe C:\Users\[your-username]\
AppData\Roaming\Thunderbird C:\Users\[your-username]\Desktop\
Thunderbird_%All% /S /E /H
echo Backup completed.
pause
```

GhostScript

To configure a PDF printer, first install GhostScript and RedMon, the Redirection Port Monitor. I have installed GhostScript in C:\ so its directory is C:\gs9.15. The next step is to add a new printer on the port RPT1. The driver for the HP ColorLaserJet 2800 PS works because it's both colour and postscript. For this printer, choose a name you like – for example, GS2PDF. Then put the following code in the file C:\gs9.15\pdfwrite.txt:

```
-IC:\gs9.15\lib;C:\gs9.15\fonts
-sDEVICE=pdfwrite
-dPDFSETTINGS=/prepress
-dCompatibilityLevel=1.4
-dNOPAUSE
-dSAFER
-sPAPERSIZE=a4
-r600
```

The last step is the configuration of the RPT1 port on which the GS2PDF printer is installed, as shown in Figure 3. Also, under *Device Settings*, set *Send Ctrl-D* before each job to 'No' and 'Wait Timeout' to 1 second. The arguments for GhostScript are as follows:

```
@C:\gs9.15\pdfwrite.txt -sOutputFile="%1.pdf" -c .setpdfwrite
-f -
```

This first part about GhostScript is based on the notes written by Michael B. McClelland (Reference 1) and by Henrik Schmiediche (Reference 2). On PDF files, there are some common operations that are easy to carry out on Windows. If I need to extract some pages from a large PDF file, I use the following batch script. It's only necessary to specify the first and the last page numbers to extract the input and the output file names.

```
@rem PDF extract
@echo off
cd C:\gs9.15\bin
gswin32c.exe -sDEVICE=pdfwrite -dPDFSETTINGS=/prepress
-dNOPAUSE -dBATC -dSAFER -dQUIET ^
-dFirstPage=2 ^
-dLastPage=6 ^
-sOutputFile="C:\Users\[your-username]\extract4.
pdf" ^
```